



City of Cambridge

COF 2026-112
FIRST IN COUNCIL
September 14, 2026

Dear Honorable Mayor Siddiqui and Councillors,

Attached you will find the Legislative Update which includes Pending Home Rule Petition Report, List of Committee Referrals, and Pending Zoning Petitions and Municipal Ordinances Chart.
I am available should you have questions.

Best,

A handwritten signature in cursive script, reading "Paula M. Crane".

Paula Crane
Interim City Clerk

A true copy;

ATTEST:-

A handwritten signature in cursive script, reading "Paula M. Crane".

Paula M. Crane,
Interim City Clerk



City of Cambridge

A communication has been received from Interim City Clerk Paula Crane, regarding an update regarding legislative activity.

PENDING HOME RULE PETITIONS UPDATE – SEPTEMBER 14, 2026

HD 4706, An Act Requiring That Broker Fees in the City of Cambridge be Paid by the Party Who Solicits a Licensed Broker was filed by Representative Connolly. House - Referred to the Committee on Housing May 15, 2025. Senate – Senate concurred May 19, 2025. Joint – Hearing scheduled for November 19, 2025 from 11:00AM-5:00PM in Gardner Auditorium. House – Reported by committee to Clerk’s Office for processing, will accompany a study order. House – Accompanied a study order, see H5352 (under House Rule 27) April 13, 2026. For legislative history: <https://malegislature.gov/Bills/194/HD4706>

HD 4735, An Act Further Regulating Procurements By The City of Cambridge, adopted by the City Council on March 24, 2025, was filed by Representative Decker on May 21, 2025. House – Referred to the Committee on Municipalities and Regional Government May 27, 2025. Senate – Senate concurred May 29, 2025. Joint – Hearing scheduled for June 24, 2025 from 1:00PM-5:00PM in B-1. House – Bill reported favorably by committee and referred to the committee on Housing Steering, Policy and Scheduling July 16, 2025. House – Committee reported that the matter be placed in the Orders of the Day for the next sitting August 14, 2025. House – Rules suspended August 14, 2025. House – Read second and ordered to a third reading August 14, 2025. For legislative history: <https://malegislature.gov/Bills/194/HD4735>

H.3924, An Act expanding the definition of dependent for the purposes of municipal employee benefits as to the City of Cambridge. This legislation was filed by Representative Decker. House - Referred to the Committee on Public Service on March 20, 2025. Senate – Senate concurred December 15, 2025. Joint – Hearing scheduled for January 27, 2026 from 1:00PM-5:00PM in B-1 January 17, 2026. Joint – Hearing rescheduled to January 27, 2026 from 1:00PM-1:15PM in B-1 and Virtual January 27, 2026. House – Bill reported favorably by committee and referred to the committee on House Steering Policy and Scheduling April 2, 2026. House – Committee reported that the matter be placed in the Orders of the Day for the next sitting April 23, 2026. House – Rules suspended April 23, 2026. House – Read second and ordered to a third reading April 23, 2026. For legislative history: <https://malegislature.gov/Bills/194/HD4279>

2026-2027 COMMITTEE REFERRAL LIST
(As of 9/10/2026)

Civic Unity Committee

That the Government Operations, Rules & Claims Committee and the Civic Unity Committee hold a joint meeting as soon as possible to discuss the topic of including foreign policy resolutions in regular City Council meetings. POR 2026-101 of May 11, 2026.

Economic Development & University Relations Committee

That the City Manager is requested to work with relevant City departments to develop a plan for inclusive and robust engagement on any proposed licensing changes, and to ensure that the City's licensing framework remains as efficient, accessible, and streamlined as the law allows, without imposing unnecessary barriers or burdens on licensees. POR 2026-124 of June 22, 2026.

That the City Manager is requested to evaluate the impacts of the temporary extended last call and public outdoor drinking district measures during the authorization period, consult with the License Commission, Cambridge Police Department, and other relevant stakeholders on the feasibility and desirability of making these measures permanent, and identify any necessary changes or actions required for implementation beyond the current authorization. POR 2026-130 of June 22, 2026.

Finance Committee

A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to Awaiting Report Item Number 26-20 regarding a report on major capital initiatives at or above \$15,000,000 for the period from FY21 to FY26. CMA 2026-91 of April 27, 2026.

Government Operations, Rules & Claims Committee

That the Government Operations, Rules & Claims Committee and the Civic Unity Committee hold a joint meeting as soon as possible to discuss the topic of including foreign policy resolutions in regular City Council meetings. POR 2026-101 of May 11, 2026.

Housing Committee

That the City Manager is requested to direct the Community Development Department, and other relevant City departments, to examine and report back to the City Council with a feasibility analysis with findings, options, and recommendations regarding the following proposed amendments to the multifamily zoning ordinance. POR 2026-123 of June 8, 2026.

Human Services & Veterans Committee

A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to a response to Awaiting Report Item Number 26-23 regarding the Cambridge Preschool Program. CMA 2026-92 of April 27, 2026.

Neighborhood & Long Term Planning, Public Facilities, Arts & Celebration Committee

That the City Manager is requested to direct the Community Development Department, and other relevant City departments, to examine and report back to the City Council with a feasibility analysis with findings, options, and recommendations regarding the following proposed amendments to the multifamily zoning ordinance. POR 2026-123 of June 8, 2026.

Ordinance Committee

A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to Awaiting Report Item Number 24-26, regarding clarification on the Wage Theft Ordinance. CMA 2024 #196 of September 9, 2024.

A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to a Mass Ave Active Use zoning petition. CMA 2026-112 of April 27, 2026 (Ordinance 2026-05).

A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to a Cambridge Street Active Use zoning petition. CMA 2026-113 of April 27, 2026 (Ordinance 2026-06).

A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to potential alternative methods of curb cut review. CMA 2026-214 of August 3, 2026.

A Zoning Petition Has been received from Michelle Lower of Alexandria Real Estate Equities, Inc. transmitting a proposed Zoning Ordinance to amend the provisions of Section 13.59.42 if the Zoning Ordinance to allow for the transfer of 250,000 square feet of Gross Floor Area from the PUD-4C Zoning District on the Industry B Zoning District in exchange for the conversion of the existing brick and beam structure at 161 First Street into Affordable Housing. The Petition seeks to amend the Zoning Map by creating the "Technology Square Transfer Receiving District." PET 2026-03 of August 3, 2026.

Public Safety Committee

A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to a Violence Prevention Recommendations Report from the Community Safety Department. CMA 2026-26 of February 9, 2026.

A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to the Police Review & Advisory Board Quarterly Report for the period of Fall 2025 through the First Quarter of 2026. CMA 2026-85 of April 13, 2026.

Transportation & Public Utilities Committee

A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to Awaiting Report 26-07 regarding restrictions to eligibility for on-street resident parking. CMA 2026-202 of June 22, 2026.

9/10/26

PENDING ZONING PETITIONS AND MUNICIPAL ORDINANCES CHART

	In City Council	Referred to Ordinance Committee	Ordinance First Hearing Date & Date Published	Passed to a 2 nd Reading & Date Published	Planning Board Hearing	Date Rpt. Rec'd (at least 21 days before ordination date)	Expiration Date (if applicable)/Comments
A communication transmitted from the City Manager, relative to Awaiting Report Item Number 24-26, regarding clarification of the Wage Theft Ordinance. CMA 2024 #196. Municipal	September 9, 2024	September 9, 2024			N/A	N/A	N/A
Mass Ave Active Use Zoning Petition. ORD 2026-05 Zoning	April 27, 2026	65 days = July 1 April 27, 2026	June 16 @ 3:00pm Published 5/28 & 6/4 July 7 @ 3:00PM (continued – no ad necessary)	Passed to a second reading as amended by substitution in Council 8/3/26 Published 8/13	June 2 @ 6:45PM		Passed to a second reading as amended by substitution in Council 8/3/26. Can ordained on or after 8/24. Must be finalized at the 9/14 Council meeting. Expires September 14, 2026
Cambridge Street Active Use Zoning Petition (Lechmere, Windsor, and Webster). ORD 2026-06 Zoning	April 27, 2026	65 days = July 1 April 27, 2026	June 16 @ 3:00pm Published 5/28 & 6/4 July 7 @ 3:00PM (continued – no ad necessary)	Passed to a second reading in Council 8/3/26 Published 8/13	June 2 @ 6:30PM		Passed to a second reading in Council 8/3/26. Can ordained on or after 8/24. Must be finalized at the 9/14 Council meeting. Expires September 14, 2026

9/10/26

PENDING ZONING PETITIONS AND MUNICIPAL ORDINANCES CHART

Short-Term Rentals (STR) Zoning Ordinance CMA 2026-188 Zoning	June 22, 2026	65 days = Aug. 26	August 19 @ 3:00PM – Cancelled due to lack of quorum Published 7/30 and 8/6		Aug. 4 @ 6:30PM	Will need to be re-submitted at a future City Council meeting due to failure to hold a public hearing within the 65 days. New expiration date TBA
A communication transmitted from the City Manager, relative to potential alternative methods of curb cut review CMA 2026-214 Municipal	August 3, 2026	August 3, 2026				
A Zoning Petition from Michelle Lower of Alexandria Real Estate Equities, Inc. PET 2026-03 Zoning	August 3, 2026	65 days = Oct. 7	Oct. 6 @ 3:00PM To be published 9/17 and 9/24		Sept. 22 @ 6:30	Expires January 4, 2027